

3.1 Data Structures in Python

ڈیٹا سٹرکچر (Data Structure) پروگرام میں ڈیٹا کو ترتیب دینے کا طریقہ ہے۔

CS XII

Chapter 3: Programming Fundamentals

Lecture 01 of 18

3.1 Data Structures in Python

LEARN IT

A **data structure** is a way of organising values in a program so you can store them, find them and change them. Every useful program is built on data structures. Python gives you two layers:

- **Primitive data structures** — the basic types that hold **one** value. Examples: integers (`int`), floating-point numbers (`float`), and booleans (`bool`).
- **Abstract data structures** — higher-level containers built from primitive types so you can hold **many** values and run richer operations. Examples: **lists, tuples, sets, dictionaries**.

Python has these four abstract structures built in. You do not install anything extra. That is why collecting marks, names or settings is simpler in Python than in many other languages.

Category	Description	Examples
Primitive	Basic types that represent a single value.	<code>int</code> , <code>float</code> , <code>bool</code>
Abstract	Higher-level structures for collections and complex operations.	Lists, tuples, sets, dictionaries

WORKED EXAMPLE

One value versus a collection. A student's age is one integer. That student's three test marks need a list.

```
age = 17
height = 5.8
passed = True
marks = [80, 75, 90]
print(type(age))
print(type(height))
print(type(passed))
print(type(marks))
```

OUTPUT

```
<class 'int'>
<class 'float'>
<class 'bool'>
<class 'list'>
```

`type()` tells you which structure a value has. `age` is a primitive integer. `marks` is an abstract list that holds three integers together.

REMEMBER IT

Primitive = one piece. Abstract = a box of pieces. Think of a single rupee coin (primitive) versus a wallet that can hold many coins (list, tuple, set or dictionary).

COMMON MISTAKE

Do not call a list a “variable type” and stop there. A list is a **structure**: it has an order, methods, and rules. The four abstract structures look similar at first (they all hold several values) but they follow different rules. Learn those rules one by one in 3.1.1–3.1.4.

اردو میں سمجھیں

ڈیٹا سٹرکچر (Data Structure) پروگرام میں ڈیٹا کو ترتیب دینے کا طریقہ ہے۔ پرائمیٹو اقسام جیسے عدد (int) صرف ایک قیمت رکھتی ہیں، جبکہ فہرست، ٹیپل، سیٹ اور ڈکشنری کئی قیمتیں ایک ساتھ سنبھالتی ہیں۔ پائتھن میں یہ چاروں سٹرکچرز پہلے سے موجود ہیں، اس لیے ڈیٹا جمع کرنا دوسری زبانوں کے مقابلے میں آسان ہے۔

CHECK YOURSELF

1. Name two primitive types and two abstract data structures in Python.
2. Why is a list called an abstract data structure rather than a primitive type?

Answers: 1. Primitive: any two of `int`, `float`, `bool`. Abstract: any two of `list`, `tuple`, `set`, `dictionary`. 2. Because it is a higher-level container built from primitive values, holding many items and supporting operations such as `append` and `slice`.

Next lecture: 3.1.1 Lists (Ordered, Mutable, Methods)